Diamond and Parekh got on cordially from the start. In fact Parekh and his wife Hira received Diamond and his wife Lois at the airport and the party drove back in Parekh's Dodge. Diamond's office was next to Parekh's on the floor ICICI had rented in the Union Bank building at the junction of Apollo and Dalal Streets, and the two spent two or three hours together everyday. Parekh quizzed Diamond on a number of issues including specific applications, methods of appraisal, and the methods followed by development banks abroad.

In a few weeks, Diamond reported confidentially to the World Bank that Parekh had been a pleasant surprise. Apart from his financial knowledge, he was a storehouse of information on enterprises and people. Parekh was accessible and easy-going and Diamond suggested that the World Bank invite him to the US to get to know him better. As for Diamond, he found himself in the unique position of having to advise both the ICICI and his superiors at the World Bank. The bank paid his salary but ICICI paid for everything else. He briefed Mehta and Parekh on what to expect when the duo went to Washington in mid 1959 to negotiate the bank's second loan to ICICI. At the same time, Diamond briefed the World Bank on the issues it should raise with the visitors.

The friendship between Parekh and Diamond seems to have blossomed quickly. The Parekhs accompanied the Diamonds on a trip to Sri Lanka in late 1959 and the next year the Parekhs were hosted by the Diamonds for six weeks when they visited the US on the occasion of the negotiation of the ICICI's third loan from the World Bank. Parekh and Diamond even toyed with the idea of co-authoring a book but nothing came of it. Diamond did, however, write the Foreword to Parekh's account of ICICI, *The Story of a Development Bank, ICICI 1955–79*. The last time Diamond met Parekh was in 1989 when the couple visited India. Parekh was by then a shadow of his former self and a far cry from the erect and robust man who had received them at the airport three decades ago.

Mehta was also instrumental in getting James S. Raj to ICICI. Raj, who went on to succeed Parekh as the Chairman of ICICI, recalls that he had returned to India in 1959 and was having trouble getting back into the Secretariat hierarchy at New Delhi. He was, as he called it, more or less exiled to Bombay as Additional Director of Stock Exchanges. Raj called on Mehta who had by then been the Chairman of ICICI for nearly a year.